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Challenges in a world in transition- M2

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Gender inequalities

Last time/ Stratification

- Stratification
  - Social class : Hierarchy based on occupation
    - Social class associated with valuable goods (well-being, living standards, health)
  - Social status: Subjective ranking of individuals or groups *in terms of honor esteem and respect*
    - *Occupational prestige; According to social group belonging*
  - Income and wealth
    - The Gini Coefficient: It summarizes the **overall stratification** within a society
    - Income stratification - the “one percent”

Today

- Focus on gender inequalities
- Definition
- Measurement(s) of gender equality
- Global aspects of gender (in)equalities

How would you define gender equality?

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Useful resource: UN Glossary on Gender equality
https://www.unicef.org/rosa/media/1761/file/Genderglossarytermsandconcepts.pdf

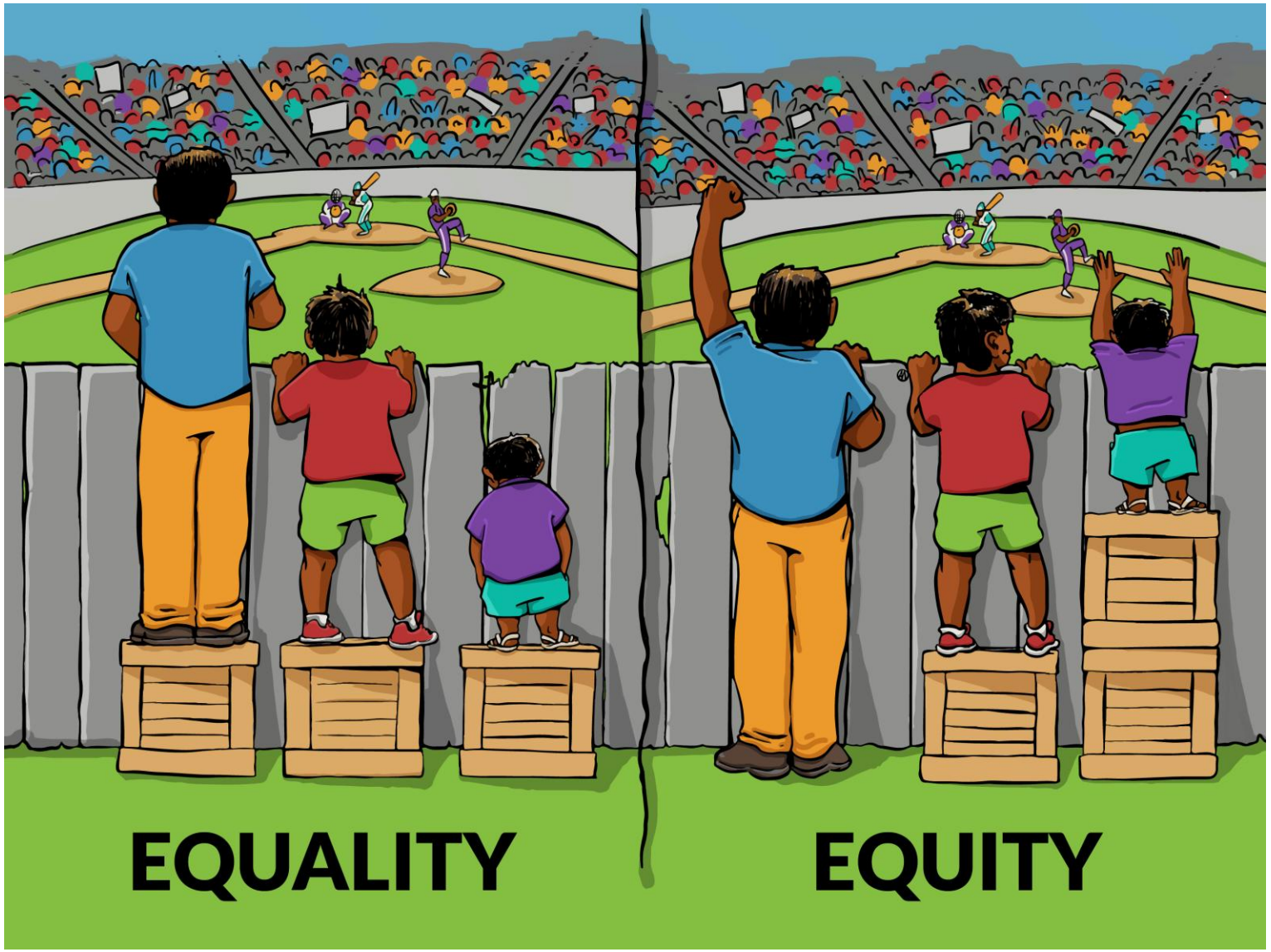
Gender equality (UN definition)

- The concept that women and men, girls and boys have **equal conditions, treatment and opportunities** for realizing their full potential, human rights and dignity, and for contributing to (and benefitting from) economic, social, cultural and political development.
- Gender equality is, therefore, the **equal valuing by society of the similarities and the differences of men and women, and the roles they play**. It is based on women and men being full partners in the home, community and society. Equality does not mean that women and men will become the same but that women's and men's rights, responsibilities and opportunities *will not depend* on whether they are born male or female.
- Gender equality implies that the interests, needs and priorities of both women and men and girls and boys are *taken into consideration*, *recognizing the diversity* of different groups and that all human beings are free to develop their personal abilities and make choices without the limitations set by stereotypes and prejudices about gender roles.

- **Gender equality is a matter of human rights** and is considered a precondition for, and indicator of, sustainable people-centred development.

Gender equity (UN definition)

- The **process of being fair** to men and women, boys and girls, and importantly the **equality of outcomes and results.**
- Gender equity may involve the use of temporary special measures to compensate for historical or systemic bias or discrimination. It refers to differential treatment that is fair and positively addresses a bias or disadvantage that is due to gender roles or norms or differences between the sexes.
- Equity **ensures** that women and men and girls and boys have an equal chance, *not only at the starting point, but also when reaching the finishing line*.
- It is about the **fair and just treatment** of both sexes that *takes into account the different needs of the men and women, cultural barriers and (past) discrimination of the specific group.*


EQUALITY
EQUITY

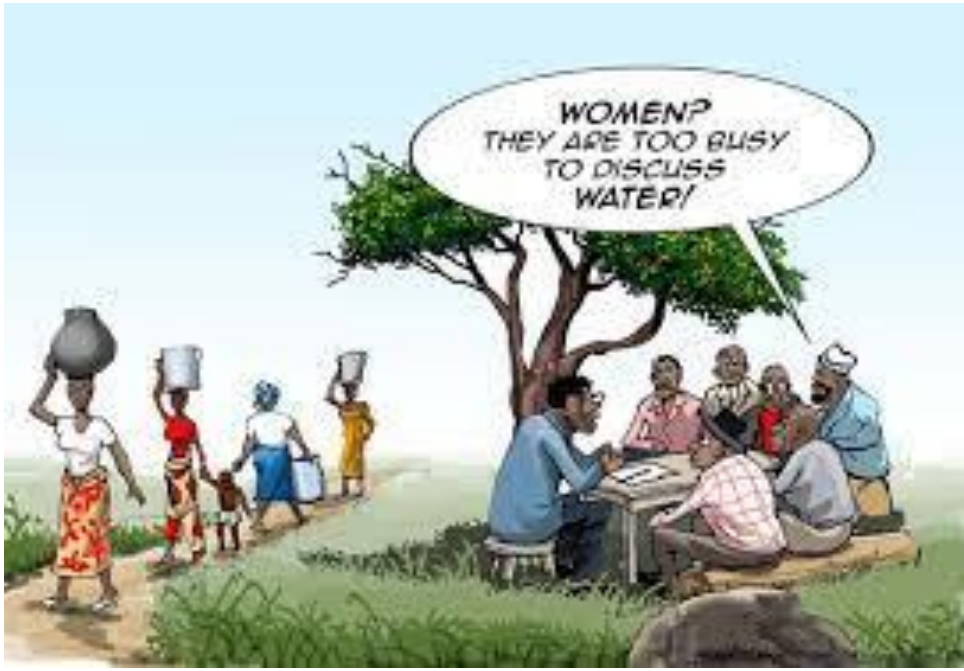
Example of dimensions of gender inequalities

- Health and Reproductive rights
- Family rights
- Access to education
- Economic inequality (horizontal/vertical segregation; gender pay gap)
- Power and decision making
- …….

Manels



Discussing health issues and benefits (maternity included), 2017 https://www.bbc.com/news/world-us-canada-39375228



About manels:
https://www.theguardian.com/world/2015/may/28/congrats-you-have-an-all-male-panel-creator-viral-tumblr
https://www.speakoutrevolution.co.uk/the-speak-out-blogs/the-unseen-consequences-of-all-male-panels-manels

How to measure gender equality?

- Gender equality is a multidimensional concept
- Instruments to measure it can differ significantly based on which dimensions they investigate, on which spheres of life they focus and the degree to which macro and/or micro perspectives are included.

- Macro/micro level
- Sphere: domestic/public

Micro perspective

- Domestic
  - Power dynamics between partners
  - Inequalities among siblings
  - Relations with parents
  - …

- Public
  - Labor market
  - Education
  - Decision-making process
  - social and political participation
  - ….

Macro perspective

- Gender equality could be measured by considering institutional and contextual (macro) aspects
- For example, the rate of women employed in technical vs. service sectors can provide an indicator of the labour market's horizontal segregation,
- laws can provide indicators of the legal climate for norms and practices related to the opportunities for women and men.
- Let's take the case of Poland, where, until 1996, women were not allowed to work in some jobs, e.g., driving public transportation vehicles

How to measure gender equality

- A single solid indicator of gender equality does not exist, but instead, several strategies can be adopted to identify and measure the level of gender equality in society.
- information **that official statistical offices** collect can be used to compute indices. Several transnational agencies adopt this strategy to compare gender equality across societies and over time, considering different dimensions.
- information from individuals **through surveys among population samples** (surveys on what people do, but also on what people think and believe about gender-equality issues, or concerning the role that they believe women and men should have in society)

Examples

- Indexes that transnational agencies have developed – such as the **United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), the Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD),** the World Economic Forum (WEF) and the European Institute for Gender Equality (EIGE)
- Eurobarometer/**European Values Study /World Values Survey/** International Social Survey Programme

UNPD Measurements of gender equality (I)

- The UNDP has examined females' status since 1995 when, in the frame of the **Human Development Index (HDI)**, two specific indices were added to consider the gender dimension in the human-development perspective:
  - **Gender-related Development Index (GDI)**, launched to evaluate evaluating to what extent gender differences in life expectancy, education and income affect human development.
    Not a pure measure of inequality between men and women, but adjusts the Human Development Index so that it could factor in gender differences
  - **Gender Empowerment Measure (GEM)**, the UNDP measured, apart from the HDI, women's empowerment, with an emphasis on economic and political life, as well as the decision-making process.
    Concerns on the comparability between different parts of the world, e.g., between Western urban areas and developing nations' rural areas ,gaps in resources were not taken into account

UNPD Measurements of gender equality (II)

- In 2010, a new measurement was introduced:
- Gender Inequality Index (GII), which aimed to measure gender inequities in three domains of human development:
  - reproductive health, measured by maternal mortality ratio and adolescent birth rates;
  - political empowerment, measured by the proportion of parliamentary seats that females occupy and the proportion of adult females and males age 25 and older with at least some secondary education;
  - and women's economic participation compared with that of men in that particular country.
- The index, computed annually, is published in the annual Human Development Report

Link to the UNPD report https://hdr.undp.org/data-center/human-development-index#/indicies/HDI

UNPD Measurements of gender equality (III)

- In 2023, two new measurements, cooperation UNPD+UNWOMEN (Strong connection with UN Agenda 2030)
- The Women's Empowerment Index (WEI) measures women's power and freedoms to make choices.
- The Global Gender Parity Index (GGPI) assesses gender disparities in key dimensions of human development.
- Less than 1 per cent of women and girls live in a country with high women's empowerment and a small gender gap.
- Globally, women are empowered to achieve, on average, *only 60 per cent of their full potential*, as measured by the WEI, and *women achieve, on average, 28 per cent less than men across key human development dimensions*, as measured by the GGPI.
- These disparities are harmful not just to women's well-being and advancement but also to human progress.

Link to the report https://www.unwomen.org/en/digital-library/publications/2023/07/the-paths-to-equal-twin-indices-on-womens-empowerment-and-gender-equality

OECD SIGI

The Social Institutions and Gender Index (**SIGI**) designed by the Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) looks at the institutional basis of gender inequality.

- It considers discrimination against women in four areas,
- focusing on formal and informal, social norms and practices that limit the full participation of women to social life and restrict their access to human rights.
- Levels of discrimination:

Very low	Low	Medium	High	Very high
SIGI < 20%	20% < SIGI < 30%	30% < SIGI < 40%	40% < SIGI < 50%	SIGI > 50%

Discrimination in the family



- Legal framework on child marriage
- Percentage of girls under 18 married
- Legal framework on household responsibilities
- Proportion of the population declaring that children will suffer if mothers are working outside home for a pay
- Female to male ratio of time spent on unpaid care work
- Legal framework on inheritance
- Legal framework on divorce

Restricted physical integrity



- Legal framework on violence against women
- Proportion of the female population justifying domestic violence
- Prevalence of domestic violence against women (lifetime)
- Sex ratio at birth (natural =105)
- Legal framework on reproductive rights
- Female population with unmet needs for family planning

Restricted access to productive and financial resources



- Legal framework on working rights
- Proportion of the population declaring this is not acceptable for a woman in their family to work outside home for a pay
- Share of managers (male)
- Legal framework on access to non-land assets
- Share of house owners (male)
- Legal framework on access to land assets
- Share of agricultural land holders (male)
- Legal framework on access to financial services
- Share of account holders (male)

Restricted civil liberties



- Legal framework on civil rights
- Legal framework on freedom of movement
- Percentage of women in the total number of persons not feeling safe walking alone at night
- Legal framework on political participation
- Share of the population that believes men are better political leaders than women
- Percentage of male MP's
- Legal framework on access to justice
- Share of women declaring lack of confidence in the justice system

SIGI Overview (0-100: Higher values indicate higher inequality)

Example, a study on the Black Sea region

Country	SIGI	Discrimination in Family	Restricted physical integrity	Restricted access to productive and financial resources	Restricted civil liberties
Armenia	28	33	35	23	19
Azerbaijan	29	28	*43*	21	21
Bulgaria	23	27	16	30	20
Georgia	25	*34*	18	27	19
Greece	27	*45*	9	*33*	17
Romania	17	28	8	7	22
Russia	22	23	15	15	*32*
Turkey	25	33	8	*37*	20
Ukraine	21	23	14	18	29
Region	**24,1**	**30,4**	**18,9**	**23,4**	**22,1**

Current discussion on SIGI



Expert Group Meeting on the SIGI

Preparing for the 6th edition of the Social Institutions and Gender Index

Current discussion on SIGI

- Reviewing and refining the SIGI framework, methodology and data sources

- Assessing gender discrimination in plural legal systems
  - **Legal pluralism** refers to the coexistence of two or more legal systems in the same social field.
  - In countries with legal pluralism, different laws may apply to different groups of the population based on characteristics such as religion, ethnicity, race, class, or geographic location.
  - This presents *a challenge* when assessing gender-based discrimination in legal frameworks: not only can these laws individually create differences in terms of women's and men's rights, but it also raises questions of whether one law supersedes another

Managing data gaps

The construction of the SIGI relies on a combination of international and national data sources, including the **Demographic and Health Surveys (DHS)** and **Multiple Indicator Cluster Surveys (MICS).**

However, the **discontinuation of the DHS programme** poses a major challenge for the next edition of the SIGI.

- **Direct impact:** DHS microdata or DHS-based aggregates are used for several variables — including *women's and men's land and housing, gender gaps in asset ownership*, and *attitudes justifying intimate partner violence*
- **Indirect impact:** DHS data serve as the **primary source** for external databases that SIGI draws from, such as **UNICEF**, **UN SDG Indicator 5.3.1 on child marriage** and **UNICEF FGM/C databases**